

HLS



BRIDGE ADVISORY

Bridging People Empowering Growth

Brand CI Handbook

Marketing & Communications Guidelines

Brand overview

Who we are

HLS Bridge Advisory is an independent Business Advisory firm specializing in People Strategy, Talent Solutions and AI-enabled Business Productivity.

We partner with organizations to solve operational challenges, optimize workforce performance and accelerate business growth through practical, outcome-driven solutions.

Rather than selling technology, we focus on solving business problems by integrating the right combination of people, process, AI and automation.

Brand personality

- Competence — every deliverable reflects rigorous, considered work.
- Reliable — commitments are kept; deadlines and figures are exact.
- Intelligent — recommendations are backed by data and clear reasoning.
- Successful — the brand presents itself at the standard of top-tier advisory firms.
- Hard-working — the tone conveys effort and diligence, never shortcuts.

Tone of voice

Professional and trust-building in every channel: proposals, decks, social posts, and client correspondence. Section 6 of this handbook sets out specific writing rules.

How to use this handbook

This handbook is the reference for any marketing activity, internal or external — decks, social media, proposals, signage, and print. When a placement is not covered here, default to the closest logo lockup and the color/type rules in Sections 2 through 5, rather than improvising.

Logo system — primary lockup



Anatomy

Monogram

"HLS" set in the primary serif, wide letterspacing, always in Deep Navy (or Warm Ivory when reversed).

Bridge line

A single thin gold arc — the recurring bridge motif. Sharp butt-cap ends only, never rounded.

Pylon

A sharp-edged gold rectangle crossing the arc's peak — the point of connection and support.

Descriptor

"BRIDGE ADVISORY" in the primary serif, tracked wide, always paired with the monogram.

Tagline

"Bridging People Empowering Growth" in gold italic. Optional — see Section 3 for when to drop it.

What the mark means

The arc represents the bridge between people and growth — the connective work the firm does. The pylon marks the point of stability at the center of that bridge: where advisory expertise and automation meet. Do not use this mark to represent anything other than HLS Bridge Advisory.

Logo variations



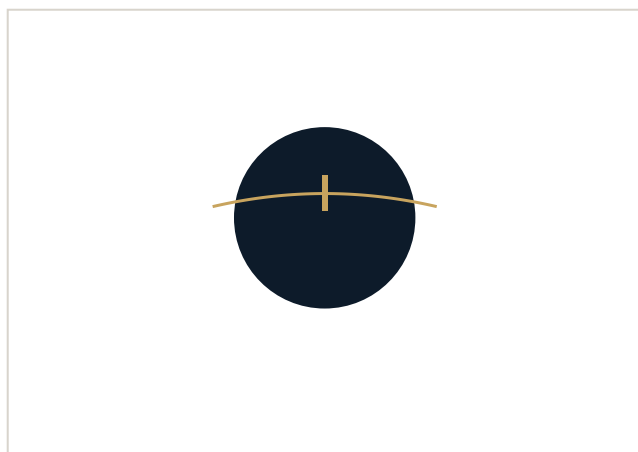
Full lockup

Primary version. Use whenever space allows.



No-tagline lockup

For small placements, or when the tagline appears elsewhere.



Icon-only mark

Favicon, app icon, social avatar, watermark. Minimum 32px.



Reversed lockup

For Deep Navy or dark photographic backgrounds only.

Clear space & minimum sizes



Dashed line = minimum clear space (1X on every side)
X = cap height of the letter "H" in the monogram

Minimum sizes

Full lockup (with tagline)

Digital: 320px wide · Print: 2 in wide

No-tagline lockup

Digital: 160px wide · Print: 1 in wide

Icon-only badge

Digital: 32px (favicon), 44px (app icon) · Print: 0.25 in

Below these sizes, drop the tagline first, then the descriptor line, then fall back to the icon-only badge. Never shrink the full lockup past legibility to force it into a small space.

Logo misuse — what to avoid



Don't distort proportions



Don't recolor outside the palette



Don't rotate the mark

Additional rules

- Don't round the pylon's corners or the arc's line caps — they must stay sharp and flat.
- Don't add drop shadows, glows, gradients, or outline strokes to the mark.
- Don't place the full-color mark on a busy photo or low-contrast background — use the reversed or icon-only version instead.
- Don't change the letterspacing, kerning, or relative size of HLS versus BRIDGE ADVISORY.
- Don't recreate the mark from scratch — always place the approved master file.

Color palette



Deep Navy

HEX #0D1B2A
RGB 13, 27, 42
CMYK 69, 36, 0, 84

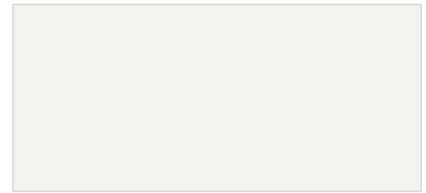
Primary — monogram, headlines, body text on light backgrounds.



Warm Gold

HEX #C8A45E
RGB 200, 164, 94
CMYK 0, 18, 53, 22

Accent — bridge line, pylon, taglines, CTAs. Use sparingly.



Warm Ivory

HEX #F4F2EE
RGB 244, 242, 238
CMYK 0, 1, 2, 4

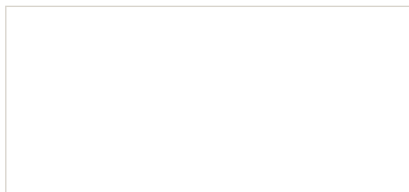
Primary light background, reversed-lockup text.



Slate Gray

HEX #6B7280
RGB 107, 114, 128
CMYK 16, 11, 0, 50

Supporting — captions, dividers, secondary text.



White

HEX #FFFFFF
RGB 255, 255, 255
CMYK 0, 0, 0, 0

Supporting — clean backgrounds, reversed text on navy.



Charcoal

HEX #2E3440
RGB 46, 52, 64
CMYK 28, 19, 0, 75

Supporting — dense body copy where pure navy is too heavy.

Typography

Primary — Cormorant Garamond

(Shown here in Liberation Serif as a placeholder — install Cormorant Garamond for production files.)

Bridging People, Empowering Growth

Use for: logo wordmark, page headlines, pull quotes, section titles.

Secondary — Montserrat

(Shown here in Lato as a placeholder — install Montserrat for production files.)

Clear, confident, built for the work.

Use for: body copy, UI text, captions, tables, contact details, email.

Hierarchy reference

STYLE	TYPEFACE	SIZE	COLOR	USE CASE
H1	Cormorant Garamond, Bold	28–36pt	Deep Navy	Page titles, cover headlines
H2	Cormorant Garamond, Regular	18–22pt	Deep Navy	Section headers
Body	Montserrat, Regular	10–12pt	Charcoal	Paragraphs, descriptions
Caption	Montserrat, Regular	8–9pt	Slate Gray	Footnotes, image captions
Accent	Cormorant Garamond, Italic	10–14pt	Warm Gold	Taglines, pull quotes

Voice & tone for marketing copy

Principles

- Direct and confident — state the point first, support it after. No throat-clearing.
- Benefit-led — describe what changes for the client, not just what the service is.
- Precise over vague — use specific numbers, timeframes, and outcomes wherever they exist; never round up or imply results that have not been confirmed.
- Earned authority, not hype — the Hero/Innovator archetype shows competence through clarity, not superlatives.

Before / after

Avoid: *We leverage synergies to foster growth.*

Use: We cut manual work by automating the steps that used to take your team hours.

Avoid: *Our solution is a testament to innovation.*

Use: We built this because the old process was slowing your team down.

Avoid: *We delve into your operations to utilize best practices.*

Use: We review your workflow and fix the three steps costing you the most time.

Banned words and phrases

delve, testament, tapestry, leverage, utilize, foster, synergy — and any phrase that sounds generated rather than written. If a sentence would fit in any competitor's marketing, rewrite it.

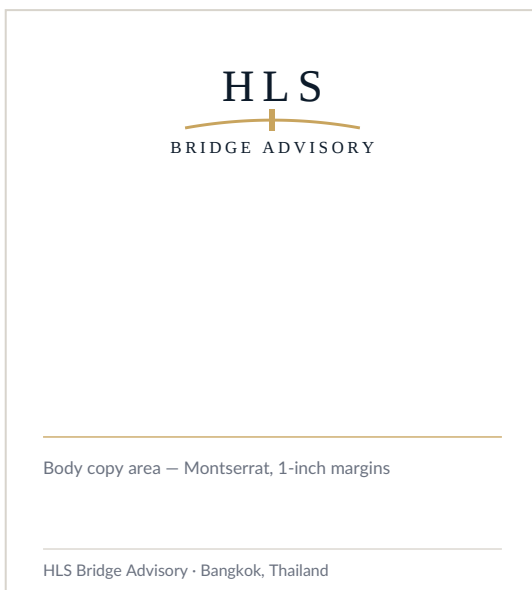
Applications

Business card — split layout



Full-size mockup: hlsbridge_bizcard-mockup_v4.svg

Letterhead



Email signature

- Icon-only badge (24–32px) or no-tagline lockup, left-aligned.
- Name in Montserrat Bold, title in Warm Gold beneath it.
- No background color; sits on the email client's default white.

Social avatar

- Icon-only badge on Deep Navy, centered with equal padding.
- Never crop the arc or pylon — resize the whole badge to fit.

Asset index

All source files referenced in this handbook are stored in the Outputs folder. Use the master SVG files directly rather than re-creating the mark.

FILE	DESCRIPTION
hlsbridge_logo-master_v2.svg	Primary full lockup, sharp-line version
hlsbridge_logo-notagline_v2.svg	No-tagline lockup, small applications
hlsbridge_logo-stacked_v2.svg	Vertical composition for square/narrow placements
hlsbridge_logo-icononly_v2.svg	Icon-only mark — bare and enclosed badge
hlsbridge_logo-reversed_v2.svg	Full lockup for Deep Navy / dark backgrounds
hlsbridge_logo-guidelines_v2.svg	Clear space and minimum size reference sheet
hlsbridge_bizcard-mockup_v4.svg	Business card, split layout (current approved version)
hlsbridge_letterhead-mockup_v2.svg	Letterhead template

Production note: this handbook uses Liberation Serif and Lato as stand-ins for Cormorant Garamond and Montserrat. Replace with the licensed font files before final print or web deployment.